सत्यमेव जयते
Government of Gujarat

Industrial Training Institute

Gujarat Skill Development Mission



Shri Narendra Modi
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GUJARAT: SKILLING THE WORKFORCE BEHIND INDIA'S NEXT INDUSTRIAL LEAP

Every industrial ambition eventually runs into the same question: who will build it, run it and keep it running. Gujarat has answered that question earlier than most states. As it works toward Viksit Gujarat @2047 and a $3.5 trillion economy, the state has treated its workforce not as a downstream concern but as core infrastructure, built with the same urgency as roads, power and ports. Two missions carry this forward: the Namo Gujarat Kaushalya & Rozgar Mission (NGKRM), which unifies the state's skilling and employment schemes under one architecture, and the Pradhan Mantri Skilling and Employability Transformation through Upgraded ITIs (PM-SETU), the Centre's industry-led overhaul of India's ITI system, now taking shape fastest in Gujarat. For industry leaders assessing where to invest in talent, both are worth understanding.

The scale of the ambition is worth stating plainly. Gujarat's current labour force participation rate stands at around 55 per cent; the state's target is 65 per cent, which translates into roughly one crore additional people entering productive work by 2030. No single scheme moves a number that large. It requires a system — one that can train at volume, certify to a consistent standard, and place people in real jobs, all while industry stays involved at every step rather than being consulted after the fact.

NGKRM: ONE MISSION INSTEAD OF MANY SCHEMES

For years, India's skilling landscape suffered from fragmentation — multiple schemes, inconsistent training quality, and a mismatch between what

> "A provision of ₹226 crore has been made for the 'Namo Gujarat Kaushalya and Rojgar Mission' for building educated, skilled, and future-ready youth."
>
> – Shri Bhupendra Patel
> Hon'ble Chief Minister, Government of Gujarat

was taught and what industry actually needed. NGKRM was built to close that gap. Steered by the Directorate of Skill Development (DSD) and the Directorate of Employment and Training (DET) under the Labour, Skill Development and Employment Department, it brings the state's major training and placement programmes under one governance structure, with standardised cost norms, biometric attendance, and a single digital system tracking every trainee from enrolment to placement.

The mission's intent is to make skilling an industry-facing exercise rather than a government-run training programme that industry discovers afterward. That was visible at an Industry-Academia-Sector Skill Councils Outreach Programme held in Ahmedabad in July 2026, which drew over two hundred representatives from industry, academia and sector skill councils. The event saw memorandums of understanding signed between the National Skill Development Corporation and the DSD, Kaushalya Skill University, Gujarat Technological University and GIFT City, while sector councils for electronics, automotive and logistics briefed participants directly on hiring needs — skilling designed backward from actual jobs, rather than forward from available courses.

NGKRM also runs on a simple financial logic: money follows outcomes, not enrolment. Training partners are paid in tranches tied to verified attendance, certification and, finally, three months of confirmed employment — a structure meant to push training providers to care as much about placement as about seats filled.

PM-SETU: INDUSTRY AS CO-OWNER, NOT JUST RECRUITER

If NGKRM is the coordination layer, PM-SETU is the infrastructure investment sitting underneath it. Approved by the Union Cabinet with a five-year national outlay of ₹60,000 crore, PM-SETU is upgrading 1,000 government ITIs through a hub-and-spoke model of roughly 200 hub institutes and 800 spoke institutes, with five National Skill Training Institutes being developed into global centres of excellence, backed by co-financing from the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank.

Its real innovation is structural. Each upgraded ITI cluster is run through a Special Purpose Vehicle in which an Anchor Industry Partner takes the lead role, designing the curriculum, funding equipment and training infrastructure, and owning the placement outcome, while the state government identifies institutes and provides land and administrative support, and the Centre sets policy and releases funding. Industry stops being a recruiter waiting at the end of the pipeline and becomes a co-owner of the institute itself.



> "The ultimate success of future depends on winning the 'battle for world-class talent.'"
>
> – Shri Harsh Sanghvi
> Deputy Chief Minister, Government of Gujarat



Officials of the Labour, Skill Development and Employment Department at a state skilling recognition event, Gandhinagar